Trello vs Airtable

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Analytical or Research Question

Should a student research team use Trello or Airtable to coordinate a semester project on a minimal budget?

Answer, Response, and Summary of Results

Recommendation: I recommend **Trello** because the immediate need is a small planning software with a low cost.

Trello SWOT

- **Strengths:** Trello gives visual boards, assigned members, and due dates support task tracking. The free plan would fit this five-person team (Atlassian, n.d.).
- **Weaknesses:** Organizing relationships between tasks, articles, and datasets is less straightforward than in Airtable.
- **Opportunities:** A continuing project could use Trello in a future semster
- **Threats:** Students may stop updating cards which can leave the others with inaccurate progress information.

Airtable SWOT

- **Strengths:** Linked records can connect tasks, articles, and datasets in a shared research catalog (Airtable, n.d.-b).
- **Weaknesses:** Designing tables takes time, and the free plan has a five editor limit which can be problematic (Airtable, n.d.-a).
- **Opportunities:** A continuing research project could reuse the catalog when new students join next semester.
- **Threats:** Team growth or future pricing changes could make Airtable unaffordable for the team.

Remaining Questions and Uncertainties

The team size and workflow are assumptions. Further information on the duties of the project would also be helpful.

References

Airtable. n.d.-a. "Airtable Plans Overview." Accessed October 27, 2026. https://support.airtable.com/articles/2277136852-airtable-plans-overview.

Airtable. n.d.-b. "Linking Records in Airtable." Accessed October 27, 2026. https://support.airtable.com/articles/3370222027-linking-records-in-airtable.

Atlassian. n.d. "Trello Pricing." Accessed October 27, 2026. https://trello.com/en/pricing.